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China Battery Materials

China Battery Supply Chain on the Ground: Jul-26 production pipeline preview check

CITI'S TAKE

According to ZE Consulting, monthly battery output in June-26 turns out to be weaker than the preview check whereas monthly battery output was only up 1% MoM vs 3% MoM up in the preview check, which might be attributable to the lithium price downtrend and the inventory management before interim results season among the battery makers. ZE Consulting's dataset also suggests that Top-5 battery makers' (barring CALB) production pipeline is estimated to be up by 5% MoM in July, resuming a modest growth rate. We think this is reasonable considering demand acceleration is relatively shy during June-July each year, and we estimate the monthly battery output should gear up in Aug-26 on back of the coming on-line new capacity and the upcoming traditional peak season (Gold Sep Silver Oct).

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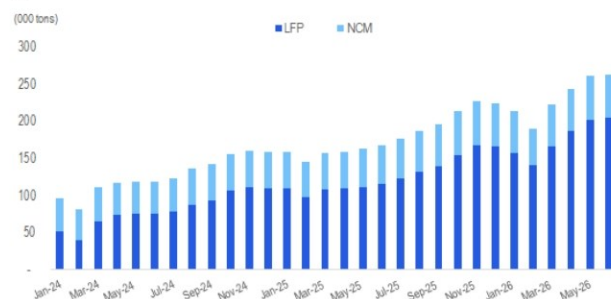
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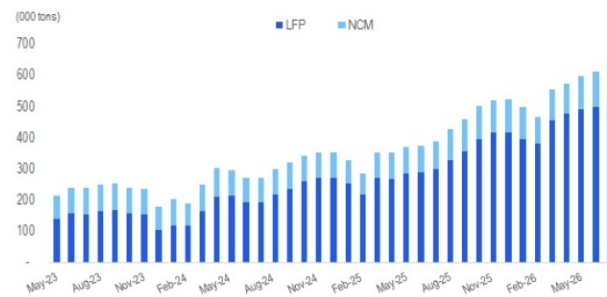
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Figure 1. Monthly battery production pipeline turns out to be +1% MoM in Jun-26



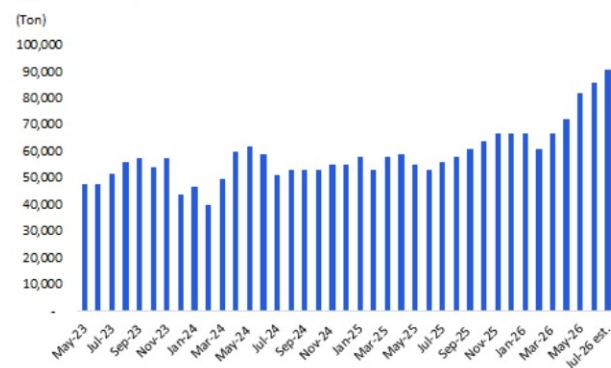
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Figure 2. Cathode production is forecasted to be +5% MoM in Jul-26



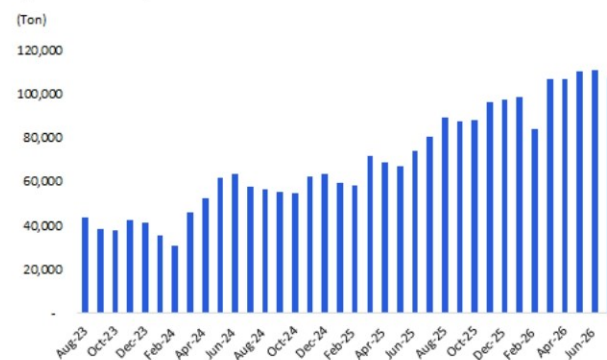
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Figure 3. Anode production is forecasted to be +6% MoM in Jul-26



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Figure 4. Lithium production is forecasted to be -3% MoM in Jul-26



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